

Project 1: Topic Selection

CSCE 242 - Web Applications – Fall 2026

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Website Name: Capitol Compass

Topic Description:

Capitol Compass is a website that will provide a visitor's guide to Washington, D.C. The website will be built for 2 primary audiences: first-time visitors trying to figure out, in one place, how to get into the building they came to see. Additionally, congressional interns who arrive on the Hill with no idea how any of it works. The site is based on first-hand experiences; I have lived in Washington, DC for 8 months in the past year, and served as a congressional intern for 4 of those and a Staff Assistant handling constituent tours for the last 4 months. During my time as a tour coordinator, coordinating Capitol and White House tour requests and running the intern program were part of my daily responsibilities, so the content reflects how the process really operates rather than what a generic travel site says about it. My goal for the site is for it to be something that a congressional office would be willing to share with their interns and constituents.

Page List:

1. **Home** – Landing page with large image of DC landmarks, orientation to the site, and entry points to each section of the site.
2. **Monuments and Memorials** – A gallery of monuments, memorials, and other landmarks, with photos and information on how to visit each of them. Links to tickets where applicable.
3. **Capitol Tours** – How capitol tours work, the difference between staff-led and member-led tours, office and public visitors center tours, how to request each type, security requirements, etc.

4. **White House Tours** - White House process explanation. The 21-day to 3-month request window, members of Congress vs public tours, the information required for every guest, background screening, and day-of logistics.
5. **Intern Survival Guide** – New intern orientation info. Dress code meanings and real examples. How to get around the Capitol Complex.